RESOURCE PROPERTY MANAGEMENT

Recording Minutes at Meetings

Every so often, a manager will come across a board member or a resident that wants the meetings minutes to read more like a movie script or novel. The intent of having Minutes is to provide a legal record of actions taken. It is not recommended that additional opinions, conversations, or personal matters be documented.

According to the Community Association Institute's M-100 course, the board meetings' actions are documented in the Minutes of said meeting. The minutes of a meeting document the decisions made during the meeting. This provides a permanent public record of positions and actions taken by a board. The secretary of the board is responsible for maintaining all official records, including the minute book of all board meetings. The following guidelines are to be followed:

Minutes should reflect what was done at a meeting, not what was said. The minutes may list the name and topic for any speaker, but not a summary of the person's remarks. Minutes should state:

- The type of meeting — such as regular or special
- Name of the group (Association, Board, or Committee)
- Date, place, and time of the meeting
- Presence of the president and secretary or their substitutes
- Presence of a quorum and the names of the board members present and absent
- Action taken on the minutes of the previous meeting and corrections, if any
- Exact wording of a motion as it is adopted, including the name of the persons making and seconding the motion (depending on state requirements, governing documents, and legal counsel preference)
- Time / Hour of adjournment

All motions passed during a community association board meeting are recorded in the minutes with the:

1. Exact wording of the motion
2. Name of the persons making and seconding the motion
3. Result of the vote (According to Robert's Rules of Order, when a motion is defeated, it does not have to be recorded.)
4. Dissenting minority vote—if those dissenting ask that it be recorded
5. In addition, any recommendations from committees should be in writing and given to the secretary to place in the minutes of the meeting.

In comparison to CAI's community association standards and guidelines for recording Minutes, **Roberts Rules of Order** have similar recommendations.

According to ***Robert's Rules of Order***, meeting minutes are the official written record of what was *done* at a meeting, not what was *said*. They should be concise, objective, and follow the agenda order.

What to Include in the Minutes

- **Meeting Details:** The type of meeting (regular, special), organization name, date, time, location, and the names of the chair and secretary.
- **Attendance:** Note the presence of the chair and secretary or their substitutes.
- **Previous Minutes:** Mention whether the previous meeting's minutes were approved (and if any corrections were made).
- **Motions:** Record all main motions that were adopted or otherwise disposed of. Include the exact wording, the name of the member who made the motion, and the final outcome (whether it passed or failed).
- **Points of Order:** Any points of order and appeals raised.
- **Adjournment:** The exact hour the meeting adjourned.
- **Speaker Names:** The names of guest speakers and their topics (without summarizing the remarks).

What to Exclude

- Do not include the opinions of the secretary or other members.
- Do not summarize the arguments made during debate.
- Do not include the contents or transcripts of officer/committee reports, unless a specific motion requires it.

If there are additional challenges or questions specific to your community association, please ask your association's legal counsel for more focused recommendations.

Thank you – Resource Property Management
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